

French Suites, date from this period. In 1729, he became director of Leipzig's Collegium Musicum, which staged weekly performances of secular music at the Zimmerman coffeehouse.



**BACH AND HIS SONS, 1730**

This painting by German portraitist Balthasar Denner is thought to depict Bach, holding a cello, with three of his sons; some historians, however, dispute that it shows the family of Bach.

## Home life and family

Bach's home became a center of music-making, in which the entire family participated. The composer wrote many works for domestic performance or as learners' pieces for his numerous offspring. Anna Magdalena gave birth to 13 children between 1723 and 1742, of whom only six survived infancy; however, the